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## Project Plan - The Collection Y.E.O. (Youth Enrichment Opportunities)

Created by: Ray-Ray Gingars | July 31st, 2024 | Application for The GLOCAL Foundation's CANConnect Microgrant

Video:  Collection Y.E.O. Video .mov .

Poster:  Poster - The Collection .png

### Introduction:

The project I am putting forth is called “The Collection Y.E.O. (Youth Enrichment Opportunities). This project centres around creating the ultimate portfolio of high school unique experiences, camps, programs, exchanges, internships, grants , summits, contests and other enrichment opportunities in Canada via a website. The purpose of this project is to create a database of quality, outside the ordinary, youth tested and approved once in the lifetime experiences that is easily accessible for Canadian youth. As a youth myself searching for such opportunities, I spent hours trying to locate some as a way to quench my thirst for more knowledge/experiences within my passions. My project aims to make connecting high school students with quality opportunities more accessible and simple. This will have a significant impact on student’s love for learning, helping to shape our future generations into passionate life long learners. The overall goal is to create a comprehensive list of youth enrichment opportunities that is accessible, one of top quality and allows a student to explore their passions at a deeper level.

### Project Goals:

Our Goals are as follows:

- Showcase 100 quality enrichment opportunities that are civically engaging in the categories of civics, law, english, arts, leadership, languages, environmental, and STEM on The Collection Y.E.O. website. (Currently there are 50)
- Develop connections with key influences/stakeholders (guidance counsellors, civics teachers, education leaders, political leaders and parents) in Ontario and Nova Scotia who can promote The Collection Y.E.O to students with the intention of ensuring youth are aware of powerful opportunities that can help raise awareness for civic information.
- Continued improvement and development of my current website to ensure opportunities showcase a wide variety of accurate information in regards to Canadian politics, current events, community interests and that are inclusive and can encourage youth to continue to contribute to the community.

- Add a welcome video to explain our resources, provide 5-10 youth testimonials to submissions, and

### **Methods and Strategies:**

I plan to dedicate time every week to research opportunities and find high quality enrichment opportunities. By putting aside time every week I believe I will steadily reach the goal of 100 opportunities.

In terms of getting the word out about The Collection to high school students I plan to get The Collection approved by the Ministry of Education of each respective province and territory. The Collection plans to start with Nova Scotia as I have met my local MP and will be spending the school year there. After receiving approval from the province I will then reach out to Nova Scotia high schools.

### **Activities and Tasks:**

The required tasks to facilitate this project are the following: - All tasks to be completed by Ray-Ray Gingras.

- Task 1 - Develop the website
  - Create the website, domains and online functionality. This was achieved already.
- Task 2 - Create Social media
  - Start Instagram, LinkedIn, Facebook and TikTok accounts.
- Task 3 - Add 100 opportunities to The Collection
  - Opportunities need to be researched, vetted, information added to the website, and then published. This will be completed by August or September.
- Task 4 - Full edit of website
  - Website needs to be checked for grammar mistakes, faulty links and authenticity of information. This will be completed in September.
- Task 5 - Posters and Marketing
  - Design posters and promotional materials for schools and other advertising venues. This will be completed in November.
- Task 6 - Reach out to Guidance counsellors
  - Request for counsellors to recommend the website and place posters in the school. This will be completed in November.

**Implementation Plan:**

The plan is broken up into two sections. Section one is development of the website and the second is marketing/raising awareness of the project. I will first focus on gathering high quality opportunities and adding them onto the website. A huge milestone will be reaching 100 opportunities. Once this milestone is achieved The Collection Y.E.O. can be presented as a legitimate resource. The next step will be to facilitate a complete edit and review of the site to double check functionality and quality. Following a review the focus will shift from development to marketing and spreading awareness of the resource. I will develop promotional materials and posters via the Canva design feature. These materials can then be printed at a service such as staples and distributed to promoters. The biggest promoter will be guidance departments and counsellors. The Collection Y.E.O. aims to target Ontario and Nova Scotia as the first two provinces. We plan to reach these guidance counsellors via email, personal connection, contacting leaders within their boards, and working with guidance counsellor associations. The second component will be obtaining permission to “advertise” or showcase our resources within these schools. This will be achieved one or a mixture of two ways. The first way is to apply to every targeted board to receive permission. The second way would be to seek provincial acceptance via the Province by setting up a meeting with my local MPP/MLA and working from there.

**Resource Allocation:**

The first major resource required is the costs of the website, which include hosting service, .com and .ca domains, as well as the development time and maintenance time required. This is the staple resource that holds substantial value in this project. When it comes to spreading awareness, marketing tools such as Canva for graphics design are huge to create professional material as well as social media posts and stories. Printable posters, as well as distribution costs will be a key element to spreading awareness once high schools are ready to promote. Promotional business cards and sweatshirts would be something to assist business development for Ray-Ray Gingras or volunteers assisting with the project.

**Monitoring and Evaluation:**

The project will be monitored by keeping track of major events, milestones, and key performance indicators by writing them down in a project journal. Some KPIs and metrics that The Collection analyzes are how many opportunities we have on the website (including by location, category ect.), number of website visitors, followers on our social platforms, and number of youth to submit their testimonial to the website. A huge milestone for our website will be 100 opportunities submitted or 1,000 followers on social media. We will refer to the journal and other metrics to generate our progress report once a month.

## **Project Timeline:**

There are two sections to the timeline; the development phase and marketing phase. The project timeline will occur as follows:

February 3rd 2024 - The Collection Y.E.O. Social Media was created

February 4th 2024 - Website was launched with 10 opportunities

February-May, 2024 - Website development occurred by Ray-Ray Gingras where the website, sections and categories, promotional material, cold email lists, opportunities list, and submission forms were created.

May 1st 2024 - Ray-Ray spoke at his school assembly to promote The Collection Y.E.O.

May 6th, 2024 - The Collection Y.E.O. reached 20 opportunities

June, 2024 - The Collection Y.E.O. begins independent research of opportunities.

July 15th 2024 -The Collection Y.E.O. reached 50 opportunities

July 31st 2024 - The Collection Y.E.O. applies for the GLOCAL Foundation's CANConnect Migrogrant

August 12th - The Collection Y.E.O reached 90 opportunities.

August 14th, 2024 - The Collection Y.E.O. reaches 100 opportunities.

August 14th -18th 2024 - The Collection Y.E.O. conducts a full review and edit of the website to prepare for presentation

August 19th - The Collection Y.E.O. enters the marketing and promotional phase of the project.

August 19th, 2024 - Ray-Ray reaches out to his local Nova Scotia MLA to set up a meeting regarding promoting The Collection Y.E.O. within high schools across Nova Scotia

August 19th, 2024 - Ray-Ray also reaches out to his Nova Scotian MP to request a meeting to explore possibilities he can help.

August 20th-31st - Marketing posters are designed and printing cost are solidified

September 2024 - Meeting with Nova Scotia MLA takes place and next steps are assessed

November 2024 - The Collection Y.E.O. is granted permission to promote it's resource within Nova Scotia high schools

November 2024 - The Collection Y.E.O. reaches out to Nova Scotian guidance counsellors about prompting the website and posters are sent out.

November 15th, 2024 project is submitted to the GLOCAL Foundation.

November 2024 - March 2025 The Collection will continue the marketing and media campaign.

## **Conclusion:**

The Collection Y.E.O. aims to be a key resource that can be recommended by educational staff, counsellors and teachers to high school students across Canada. By focusing on researching and adding opportunities, The Collection believes it can reach its goal of showcasing 100

opportunities. With key marketing tools and contacting members of parliament in Nova Scotia and then Ontario, The Collection will be approved as a resource in all public high schools of their respective provinces. . If we contact the right individuals, follow the plan and implement the strategies, I firmly believe that The Collection will become a critical resource that empowers youth to be more civically engaged, follow their passions, and unlock new educational potentials.

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## **Extras**

### **Goals:**

- ACCESSIBLE
- TOP QUALITY
- STIMULATE LEARNING and CIVIC ENGAGEMENT

### **Resources Required:**

The following resources take into account both the financial and time (human resources) costs associated with developing and managing The Collection Y.E.O. for a two year period. The period includes the development year of 2024 and the following year 2025.

These are the costs of operation for a two year plan: 2024 and 2025 years.

- 1 - **\$600** (\$300/year) - **Squarespace website hosting fees**
- 2 - **\$100** - **Logo development** - Outsourced, Weber Designs
- 3 - **\$250** (\$125/year) - **GoDaddy Domains**
- 4 - **\$60** - **Vistaprint business 250 cards**
- 5- **\$3240** - **Past human resources** - (\$18 per hour for 180 hours from February to August, 2024.) Development of website, logo consultation, research of opportunities, soliciting of testimonials, creation and management of social media platforms, marketing content development, promotion, meeting with key stakeholders). All facilitated by project leader Ray-Ray Gingras.
- 6- **\$2,160** - **future human resources** - (20 hours per month at \$18 per hour for 6 months, September 2024 - March 2025). Managing and developing social media content, researching opportunities, facilitating contests and promotion, continuing to build relationships to promote The Collection, developing marketing posters and contests, soliciting testimonials.

**TOTAL: \$6,410**

The marketing and promotional costs associated with the website are a part of our plan to raise awareness of this resource to students across Canada.

## **SUMMARY**

The project I am putting forward is called The Collection Y.E.O. (Youth Enrichment Opportunities). The idea is a website resource that showcases opportunities, extracurriculars and

experiences for Canadian high school students. We have many enrichment opportunities available to youth, however the challenge is that youth are unaware of these opportunities and their quality. Our objective is to provide a resource for high school students to turn to when they want to explore ways to educate themselves, follow their passions, empower their abilities and enrich themselves. The Collection connects students that are keen and excited to learn with the opportunities and experiences that will fuel their desires. This project makes it more accessible for Canadian youth to learn about and partake in opportunities across the civics, STEM, leadership, English, environmental change, law, art and languages fields. The Collection aligns with the GLOCAL foundation because we stimulate civic engagement and youth participation through hundreds of faucets. The Collection stimulates desire to learn, explore and contribute to your community. The Collection falls under 4 of 6 GLOCAL Categories. The project researches opportunities, provides data on opportunities, is a digital resource, and is outreaching to politicians providing information to students.

## **COSTS**

The Collection Y.E.O is a very cost effective and sustainable initiative using a simple website to make impactful change within the volunteer, civic engagement and education communities

- Sustainable as the fixed cost of maintaining this is only \$425 - Once website is fully developed it can remain for a long period of time
- The large cost is only a one time development and promotional cost - This will end once the website is completed and high school guidance counsellors will continue promotion at no cost once they are aware of the resource.
- Accessible to students across Canada and can be utilised at the convenience of youth. Available to rural students as much as urban.
- Eases burden on guidance counsellors and education system by connecting keen students to out of the classroom ways to learn, enrich and contribute
- Will continue to grow at little cost as students will be able to submit opportunities.

The accessibility, sustainability and impact make this project a great bang for your buck.

## **INGENIOUS PLUS APPLICATION**

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## **Describe the problem or opportunity your innovation addresses. How are you innovating for good? (Max 500 words)\***

The big problem within the current education system is high school students are extremely passionate about exploring their passions and future career options, but don't know where to start. Students are passionate to make a difference or curious about a profession or hobby but feel powerless or too young to take a leap. The fact is there are thousands of opportunities, programs, grants, internships, camps ect out there for high school students to become engaged or make a difference but students don't know how to find themes. The lucky students seek guidance from a knowledgeable teacher or guidance counsellor at their school who connects them to what they know. However this is not reality for many students as Guidance counsellors and teachers are so busy and preoccupied with other students. As a youth myself searching for such opportunities, I spent hours trying to locate some as a way to quench my thirst for more knowledge/experiences within my passions. My project aims to make connecting high school students with quality opportunities more accessible and simple. This will have a significant impact on student's love for learning, helping to shape our future generations into passionate life long learners. The overall goal is to create a comprehensive list of youth enrichment opportunities that is accessible, one of top quality and allows a student to explore their passions at a deeper level. The Collection Y.E.O is a very cost effective and sustainable initiative using a simple website to make impactful change within the volunteer, civic engagement and education communities. The project is Sustainable as the fixed cost of maintaining this is only \$425 - Once website is fully developed it can remain for a long period of time. The large cost is only a one time development and promotional cost - This will end once the website is completed and high school guidance counsellors will continue promotion at no cost once they are aware of the resource. The websites accessible to students across Canada and can be utilised at the convenience of youth. Available to rural students as much as urban. It also eases burden on guidance counsellors and education system by connecting keen students to out of the classroom ways to learn, enrich and contribute. Furthermore, it will continue to grow at little cost as students will be able to submit opportunities. The accessibility, sustainability and impact make this project a great bang for your buck.



**Describe your innovation in detail, including any relevant information as to how it came about. (Max 200 words)\***

The Collection Y.E.O. website currently showcases 100 quality enrichment opportunities in the categories of civics, law, english, arts, leadership, languages, environmental, and STEM. These opportunities include extracurriculars, programs, camps, summits and enrichment opportunities across Canada. The opportunities include a mix of in-person and online, as well as government-subsidized, free, scholarship and extremely expensive programs. All opportunities are available to Canadian high school students. The website acts as a database or one stop shop where students can browser and find opportunities that interest them. . The objective is to provide a resource for high school students to turn to when they want to explore ways to educate themselves, follow their passions, empower their abilities and enrich themselves. The Collection connects students that are keen and excited to learn with the opportunities and experiences that will fuel their desires. This project makes it more accessible for Canadian youth to learn about and partake in opportunities across the civics, STEM, leadership, English, environmental change, law, art and languages fields. This idea came about when I was on my own journey to search for opportunities as a student. I noticed the difficulty in finding true educational opportunities in the sea of the scary internet and wanted to make the process easy for other students.

**Tell us about your Research and Design process. What sort of background research and/or consultation have you done to support the development of your idea (e.g., consulting with the audience your innovation will impact, consulting people in the field or industry)? If referencing published research, please add a citation in a valid format.(Max 200 words)\***

The bulk of the research I've conducted has been to locate opportunities. This happened through word of mouth, my personal experiences, or careful online vetting. This included speaking with 100s of my peers to find out what opportunities they were looking for and what they would value in a resource. I've also met with high school Guidance Counsellors, University consultants, retired workers at the Ontario Ministry of Education, MPPs, MPs and parents of students. An integral part of this initiative is the "Opportunity Form" where students can submit an opportunity alongside testimonials of opportunities they've participated in that they recommend to others. The submissions are vetted for credibility and then potentially added to the website. Both students and opportunity representatives have used this feature.

## **Who does your innovation help and how? (Max 100 words)\***

The innovation helps students explore their passions, engage in their communities, and gain world experiences and connections. The website does this by making these opportunities accessible to students across the country and by highlighting important information that helps simplify the process of finding quality opportunities. The project helps educators, guidance counsellors, parents and the school system by connecting their students to outside the classroom opportunities. Lastly the project benefits both local and national communities by helping students be more active in their community and follow their passions. Overall the project maximizes civic engagement by making it more accessible and simple.

## **What is currently being done to address this problem or similar problems in your community or elsewhere? How does your project differ from existing solutions? (Max 100 words)\***

Currently there are other opportunity database solutions however The Collection has recognized their strengths and areas for improvement when developing this website. Many of these other websites showcase high school and university opportunities across the world. This can be difficult for a high school student as you need to search through a web of opportunities to find ones you're eligible for. To solve this The Collection is only for high school students and only for

Canadian high school students. Secondly many of these websites are “vomits” of hundred or thousands of opportunities. The Collection only showcases the high quality, reputable and unique opportunities.

**Are there any potential barriers to implementing your solution? If so, how might you propose overcoming them? (Max 100 words)\***

The big barrier is reaching thousands of high school students across Canada. This is a lengthy, expensive and time consuming task. I plan for a two pronged approach by reaching out to guidance counsellors and school boards to promote the website to students. I plan to reach these guidance counsellors via email, personal connection, contacting leaders within their boards, and working with guidance counsellor associations. Secondly promote via direct channels such as social media, news, posters.

**Explain who your collaborators or partners have been, or will be, as the innovation is brought to life. (Max 200 words)\***

The big collaborators will be guidance counsellors, school boards and educators to share the project to their students. This route is an uphill battle with reaching out to every school and getting board approval. To navigate this I have reached out to my MPP, Attorney General of Ontario, Doug Downey who will hopefully be introducing me to the Ontario Minister of Education, or help create movement in my local school board, SCDSB. I am going down this similar route in Nova Scotia with my MLA ( for my school) there. I have also worked with Glocal Foundation, with their guidance and support to help with the process.

**Describe how you would use the cash award to support your innovation. (Max 200 words)\***

The first major resource required is the costs of the website, which include hosting service, .com and .ca domains, as well as the development time and maintenance time required. This is the staple resource that holds substantial value in this project. When it comes to spreading awareness, marketing tools such as Canva for graphics design are huge to create professional material as well as social media posts and stories. Printable posters, as well as distribution costs will be a key element to spreading awareness once high schools are ready to promote. Promotional business cards and sweatshirts would be something to assist business development for Ray-Ray Gingras or volunteers assisting with the project.

**The Collection is a portfolio of youth enrichment opportunities for Canadian high school students. Unlike your ordinary list of extracurricular experiences, The Collection showcases unique, outside-of-the-ordinary, once-in-a-lifetime experiences.**